

D410

Health & Human Services Professional Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A care coordinator at a group home with a new vegetable garden calls the on-call nurse about a resident who has had a fever of 102 °F since noon and is not drinking. The resident enjoys painting. Which opening follows SBAR?

- A. "She loves painting and has been part of our art group."
- B. "Let me start with her history since she moved here in 2019."
- C. "I'm calling about a resident with a fever of 102 °F since noon who is not drinking."
- D. "Can you come see her?" with no other details

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In an SBAR report, which statement is the Recommendation?

- A. "I'd like you to see him within the hour and consider a urine test."
- B. "He has had no urine output for eight hours."
- C. "I think he may be dehydrated."
- D. "He has a history of kidney stones."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

After explaining a new medication schedule to a client, who is a retired mechanic and brought his reading glasses, the health services worker wants to confirm understanding. His wife usually handles his pills. What is the best approach?

- A. "To make sure I explained it well, can you tell me how you'll take these each day?"
- B. Give the schedule to his wife and skip checking with him.
- C. Hand him a detailed printout and end the visit.
- D. "Do you understand?"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

In a busy clinic that just switched to a new scheduling system, a supervisor tells a worker, "Call the lab and move Mr. Diaz's draw to 2 p.m." The worker is new to the team. What should the worker say to close the loop?

- A. "Got it."
- B. "Call the lab and move Mr. Diaz's draw to 2 p.m. — correct?"
- C. Nod and make the call.
- D. "I'm new, so I'll ask someone else to do it."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A worker repeats an instruction back to a supervisor. What must happen next to complete closed-loop communication?

- A. The supervisor repeats the message again, word for word.
- B. The supervisor confirms the repeated message is correct or corrects it.
- C. The worker writes it down for later.
- D. Nothing; repeating back completes the loop.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A client, who speaks mainly Vietnamese and runs a nail salon, needs to review a care plan. Her 12-year-old son speaks English well and offers to translate. The family arrived early. What should the worker do?

- A. Use the son only if the client agrees, in every case.
- B. Speak slowly in English and use gestures.
- C. Arrange a qualified medical interpreter, in person, by phone, or by video.
- D. Let the son interpret, since he speaks English well.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Two team leads at an agency, which moved to a four-day workweek this year, disagree about whether to spend grant money on staff training or client transportation. They meet, list what each program truly needs, and design a plan that funds mobile training on the transport routes. Which conflict mode is this?

- A. Collaborating
- B. Compromising
- C. Accommodating
- D. Avoiding

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Two coworkers settle a scheduling dispute by each giving up one preferred shift. Which mode is this?

- A. Avoiding
- B. Collaborating
- C. Competing
- D. Compromising

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A worker at a day program, who has been there six months and is well liked, nearly gives a client another client's lunch labeled with a nut allergy warning. She notices before handing it over. The two clients have similar names. What should she do?

- A. Say nothing, because no harm happened.
- B. Expect to be disciplined, since every error means punishment.
- C. Report the near miss so the labeling and name-similarity issue can be addressed.
- D. Report it only if the client had been harmed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A health services graduate, who volunteers at a food bank on weekends, is writing a professional development plan. Which goal is written in SMART form?

- A.** Become a better professional.
- B.** Volunteer more at the food bank.
- C.** Learn everything about health care this year.
- D.** Earn a community health worker certificate by completing the 120-hour course before June 30.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A goal reads: “Complete two continuing-education courses on patient privacy.” Which SMART element is missing?

- A.** Relevant
- B.** Measurable
- C.** Specific
- D.** Time-bound

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

In a job interview for a care coordinator role at a hospital that just opened a new wing, the candidate is asked, “Tell me about a time you handled an upset client.” The interviewer mentions the hospital’s parking is limited. Which answer best follows STAR?

- A.** “I once talked a client through a parking problem.”
- B.** “At my internship, a client was angry about a lost referral. I apologized, tracked it down in an hour, and he rated his visit 5 out of 5.”
- C.** “Our team handled lots of upset clients well.”
- D.** “I always stay calm with upset people.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A care coordinator at a group home ~~with a new vegetable garden~~ calls the on-call nurse about a resident who has had a fever of 102 °F since noon and is not drinking. ~~The resident enjoys painting.~~ Which opening follows SBAR?

Target word: SBAR opening **Decides:** Situation first: what is happening now.

A	Camouflage	Leads with an irrelevant detail.
B	Inverted operation	Background before situation reverses the order.
C	Correct	States the situation first.
D	Dropped element	A recommendation without the situation, background, or assessment.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

In an SBAR report, which statement is the Recommendation?

Target word: reverse: identify the R **Decides:** The specific request.

A	Correct	A clear request for action.
B	Inverted operation	Situation.
C	Adjacent category	Assessment.
D	Confusion set	Background.

3. Answer A Concept 2

After explaining a new medication schedule to a client, ~~who is a retired mechanic and brought his reading glasses,~~ the health services worker wants to confirm understanding. ~~His wife usually handles his pills.~~ What is the best approach?

Target word: confirm understanding **Decides:** Teach-back.

A	Correct	Teach-back checks understanding in the client's own words.
B	Camouflage	Uses the wife detail and leaves him out of his own care.
C	Dropped element	Drops the check for understanding.
D	Confusion set	A yes/no question often gets a yes without real understanding.

4. Answer B Concept 3

In a busy clinic ~~that just switched to a new scheduling system,~~ a supervisor tells a worker, "Call the lab and move Mr. Diaz's draw to 2 p.m." ~~The worker is new to the team.~~ What should the worker say to close the loop?

Target word: closed-loop response **Decides:** Repeat back for confirmation.

A	Dropped element	Acknowledges without repeating the details.
B	Correct	Repeating back lets the sender confirm or correct.
C	Adjacent category	Nonverbal acknowledgment cannot catch errors.
D	Camouflage	Uses the new-hire detail and avoids the task.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A worker repeats an instruction back to a supervisor. What must happen next to complete closed-loop communication?

Target word: reverse: the missing final step **Decides:** Sender confirms or corrects.

A	Inverted operation	The sender confirms; they do not restart the loop.
B	Correct	The loop closes with sender confirmation.
C	Adjacent category	Helpful, but not the confirming step.
D	Dropped element	Drops the sender's confirmation.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A client, who speaks mainly Vietnamese ~~and runs a nail salon,~~ needs to review a care plan. Her 12-year-old son speaks English well and offers to translate. ~~The family arrived early.~~ What should the worker do?

Target word: interpreter choice **Decides:** Qualified interpreter, not a child.

A	Absolute language	Client preference does not make a child a qualified interpreter for important content.
B	Dropped element	Drops the language barrier.
C	Correct	Accurate and confidential communication needs a trained interpreter.
D	Adjacent category	Children should not interpret sensitive or important information.

7. Answer A Concept 5

Two team leads at an agency, ~~which moved to a four day workweek this year,~~ disagree about whether to spend grant money on staff training or client transportation. They meet, list what each program truly needs, and design a plan that funds mobile training on the transport routes. Which conflict mode is this?

Target word: conflict mode **Decides:** Both parties' core interests are fully met.

A	Correct	A creative solution meets both sides' interests.
B	Confusion set	Compromise splits the difference so each side gives something up.
C	Adjacent category	One side yields to the other.
D	Inverted operation	Avoiding postpones the conflict.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Two coworkers settle a scheduling dispute by each giving up one preferred shift. Which mode is this?

Target word: reverse: identify compromising **Decides:** Each side gives something up.

A	Adjacent category	The issue would be left unresolved.
B	Confusion set	Collaborating meets both parties' full interests.
C	Inverted operation	One side wins at the other's expense.
D	Correct	Both sides partially give in.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A worker at a day program, ~~who has been there six months and is well liked,~~ nearly gives a client another client's lunch labeled with a nut allergy warning. She notices before handing it over. The two clients have similar names. What should she do?

Target word: respond to a near miss **Decides:** Report near misses for system learning.

A	Dropped element	Drops the value of near-miss reporting.
B	Absolute language	Just culture does not punish honest mistakes.
C	Correct	Near-miss reports reveal system problems before harm occurs.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses when reporting matters.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A health services graduate, ~~who volunteers at a food bank on weekends,~~ is writing a professional development plan. Which goal is written in SMART form?

Target word: SMART goal **Decides:** Specific, measurable, time-bound.

A	Dropped element	Not specific, measurable, or time-bound.
B	Camouflage	Uses the volunteer detail but lacks a measure and deadline.
C	Absolute language	Not achievable or specific.
D	Correct	Specific credential, measurable hours, deadline.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A goal reads: "Complete two continuing-education courses on patient privacy." Which SMART element is missing?

Target word: reverse: find the missing element **Decides:** No deadline.

A	Adjacent category	Privacy training is relevant to health services work.
B	Confusion set	"Two courses" is measurable.
C	Inverted operation	The goal names the topic and course type.
D	Correct	There is no date or timeframe.

12. Answer B Concept 8

In a job interview for a care coordinator role ~~at a hospital that just opened a new wing,~~ the candidate is asked, "Tell me about a time you handled an upset client." ~~The interviewer mentions the hospital's parking is limited.~~ Which answer best follows STAR?

Target word: STAR answer **Decides:** Specific situation, own action, measurable result.

A	Camouflage	Uses the parking detail without task, action, or result.
B	Correct	Situation, task, the candidate's own action, and a result.
C	Adjacent category	Describes the team, not the candidate's own actions.
D	Absolute language	A general claim, not a specific example.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SBAR handoff	Structure urgent reports as Situation (what is happening now), Background (relevant history), Assessment (what you think is going on), Recommendation (what you need).	Opening with long history before stating the problem, or leaving out a clear request.	Preparing a call or handoff about a change in a client.
2	Teach-back	Confirm understanding by asking the client to explain or show the information in their own words; it checks the teaching, not the client.	Asking “Do you understand?” and accepting a yes.	The end of client education or instructions.
3	Closed-loop communication	The receiver repeats the message back and the sender confirms it, so errors are caught before action.	Assuming a nod or “got it” means the message was received correctly.	A verbal order or instruction in a busy setting.
4	Qualified interpreters	Use a trained, qualified interpreter for clients with limited English proficiency; family members, especially children, should not interpret important information.	Using a bilingual relative because it is faster or the client prefers it.	A client who speaks limited English and an important conversation.
5	Conflict-handling modes	Collaborating seeks a solution that meets both parties’ core interests; compromising splits the difference; avoiding postpones; accommodating yields; competing pushes one side.	Calling any agreement a collaboration, or thinking avoiding solves the conflict.	A team disagreement and a description of how it was handled.
6	Just culture and error reporting	Report errors and near misses so systems can be fixed; just culture separates honest mistakes and system flaws from reckless behavior.	Hiding near misses because no harm occurred or expecting punishment for every error.	A mistake caught before it reached the client.
7	SMART goals	Career and professional goals should be Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.	Writing a broad wish (“get better at my job”) and calling it a goal.	A professional development plan with a goal statement.
8	STAR interview answers	Answer behavioral interview questions with Situation, Task, Action, and Result, focusing on your own actions and a measurable outcome.	Describing the team’s work or a general belief instead of a specific example.	“Tell me about a time when...”

Course scope (public description): Health Services Professional Capstone will provide learners the opportunity to demonstrate their ability to communicate in a professional manner that supports high quality, safe client services. Learners will also engage in career and professional development within the health and human services industry. All program coursework leads to this course.